Overview

Each row is a US child aged 2 to 6 who was examined in NHANES 2021 to 2023, and each column comes from six files which are joined using `SEQN` (unique per person).

File	Contents
`DEMO_L`	Demographics, income, household reference person, survey weights
`BMX_L`	Body measures: weight, height, BMI
`CBC_L`	Complete blood count: hemoglobin, hematocrit(low implies nutrient deficiency)
`ECQ_L`	Early childhood: birth weight
`DBQ_L`	Diet behavior: ages feeding stopped or started
`FSQ_L`	Food security and program participation

Variable dictionary

Column	File	Meaning	Units	Who answers
`SEQN`	all	Respondent ID	Unique per person	Everyone
`RIDSTATR`	DEMO	Interview / exam status	1 interview only, 2 interviewed and examined	Everyone
`RIAGENDR`	DEMO	Sex	1 implies male, 2 implies female	Everyone
`RIDAGEYR`	DEMO	Age at screening	Years	Everyone
`RIDAGEMN`	DEMO	Age at screening in months	Months	Only infants, so empty for most ages 2 to 6
`RIDEXAGM`	DEMO	Age at exam in months	Months	Under 20 years; is needed for growth z-scores

Column	File	Meaning	Units	Who answers
`RIDRETH3`	DEMO	Race / Hispanic origin	Coded categories	Everyone
`DMDBORN4`	DEMO	Country of birth	1 for US, 2 for elsewhere	Everyone
`DMDHHSIZ`	DEMO	People in household	Count	Everyone
`DMDHRGND`	DEMO	Gender of household reference person	1 for male, 2 for female	Everyone
`DMDHRAGZ`	DEMO	Age group of reference person	Grouped	Everyone
`DMDHREDZ`	DEMO	Education of reference person	Grouped levels	Everyone
`DMDHSEDZ`	DEMO	Education of reference person's spouse	Grouped levels	Only if there is a spouse
`DMDHRMAZ`	DEMO	Marital status of reference person	Coded categories	Everyone
`INDFMPIR`	DEMO	Family income to poverty ratio	0 to 5, capped at 5	Everyone, some may refuse to have this on record
`WTINT2YR`, `WTMEC2YR`	DEMO	Survey weights (interview, exam)	Use `WTMEC2YR` for exam variables	Everyone
`SDMVSTRA`, `SDMVPSU`	DEMO	Survey design strata and PSU	Needed for design-correct variance	Everyone
`BMXWT`	BMX	Weight	kg	Examined kids
`BMXHT`	BMX	Standing height	cm	Examined kids
`BMXBMI`	BMX	Body mass index	kg/m²	Examined kids
`BMXRECUM`	BMX	Recumbent length	cm	Only young children, so mostly empty by age 4

Column	File	Meaning	Units	Who answers
`LBXHGB`	CBC	Hemoglobin	g/dL (confirm)	Kids who gave blood
`LBXHCT`	CBC	Hematocrit	% (confirm)	Kids who gave blood
`ECD070A`	ECQ	Birth weight, pounds	3 means 3 lb or less; 11 means 11 lb or more; 7777 refused, 9999 don't know	Ages 0 to 15
`ECD070B`	ECQ	Birth weight, ounces	0 to 15	Ages 0 to 15
`ECQ080`	ECQ	Birth weight above or below 5.5 lb	1 more than 5.5 lb, 2 less than 5.5 lb, 7 refused, 9 don't know	Ages 0 to 15; few answers
`ECQ090`	ECQ	Birth weight above or below 9 lb	1 more than 9 lb, 2 less than 9 lb	Skipped when `ECQ080` is 2, 7 or 9
`WHQ030E`	ECQ	Parent's view of child's weight	1 implies overweight, 2 implies underweight, 3 implies that it is about right	Ages 2 to 15
`MCQ080E`	ECQ	Doctor ever said child was overweight	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 2 to 15
`DBQ010`	DBQ	Ever breastfed	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 0 to 6
`DBD030`	DBQ	Age stopped breastfeeding	Days; 0 still breastfeeding; 666666 over 1095 days	Only if ever breastfed
`DBD041`	DBQ	Age first fed formula	Days; 0 never; 666666 over 365 days	Ages 0 to 6
`DBD050`	DBQ	Age stopped formula	Days; 0 still on formula; 666666 over 1095 days	Only if ever fed formula

Column	File	Meaning	Units	Who answers
DBD055	DBQ	Age first fed anything besides milk or formula	Days; 0 never; 666666 over 730 days	Ages 0 to 6
DBD061	DBQ	Age first fed milk	Days; 0 never; 666666 over 1095 days	Ages 0 to 6
FSDAD	FSQ	Adult food security, household level	1 for full, 2 for marginal, 3 for low, 4 for very low	Everyone; repeats for every household member
FSD162	FSQ	Household got WIC in last 12 months	1 for yes, 2 for no	Household level
FSQ012	FSQ	Household got SNAP in last 12 months	1 for yes, 2 for no	Household level
FSQ165	FSQ	Household ever got SNAP	1 for yes, 2 for no	Household level
FSQ653	FSQ	Child ever got WIC	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 0 to 5 only
FSD660ZC	FSQ	Child gets WIC now	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 0 to 5; only if ever on WIC
FSD675	FSQ	Child got WIC under age 1	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 0 to 5; only if ever on WIC
FSD680	FSQ	Child got WIC between ages 1 and 4	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 1 to 5
FSD670ZC	FSQ	Months child got WIC	0 to 60; 777 refused, 999 don't know	Ages 0 to 5; only if ever on WIC
FSQ690	FSQ	Mother got WIC while pregnant	1 for yes, 2 for no	Ages 0 to 5

Columns the script adds

Column	How it is made	Notes
`birth_wt_lb`	`ECD070A` + `ECD070B` / 16	Pounds. Values of 3 and 11 are bounds, not exact weights
`low_birth_weight`	1 if `birth_wt_lb` < 5.5, else 0; if weight is missing, falls back to `ECQ080` (2 means low)	Binary outcome / parent node
`parent_edu`	`DMDHREDZ` if the reference person is female, else `DMDHSEDZ`	Proxy for mother's education
`anaemia`	Hemoglobin below 11.0 g/dL under age 5, below 11.5 at age 5 or older	WHO cutoffs
`still_breastfeeding`	`DBD030` equals 0	True / False flag
`formula_never`	`DBD041` equals 0	True / False flag
`still_formula`	`DBD050` equals 0	True / False flag
`other_food_never`	`DBD055` equals 0	True / False flag
`milk_never`	`DBD061` equals 0	True / False flag
`DBD030_censored`, `DBD041_censored`, `DBD050_censored`, `DBD055_censored`, `DBD061_censored`	Age was coded 666666, meaning older than the survey cap	The age is replaced by the cap, so these are lower bounds. Each flag is True for only a handful of kids